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# TIP-OFF

News of the American discovery of the Soviet SAMs on Cuba found Nikita Khrushchev on vacation. He had left Moscow in late July, after General Issa Pliev and the first reconnaissance groups were dispatched to Cuba, and progressed slowly south to the Black Sea—the master surveying his land and people. He checked the state of agriculture in the southern Russian provinces, visited his native village of Kalinovka, and then headed for Dnipropetrovsk to visit Mykhailo Yangel's missile factory, which produced R-12 and R-14 rockets earmarked for shipment to Cuba. He finally made it to the Crimean resort of Yalta on August 1, a few days before Colonel Ivan Sidorov and his regiment of R-12s left the harbor of nearby Sevastopol and set out for Cuba.[1] Khrushchev was sunbathing and swimming but also working—his mercurial personality made it impossible for him to stay still. In mid-August he flew to Moscow for a few days to celebrate another Soviet achievement in outer space, the return of the Soviet astronauts Pavel (Pavlo) Popovych and Adrian Nikolaev from the first dual